Humana. Claims Payment Policy

Subject: Screening Colonoscopy

Application: Medicare Advantage Products
Policy number: CP2010102
Related policies: N/A

Effective date: 06/2009
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Overview

A colonoscopy allows the physician to examine the lining of the entire large intestine. It is most often used as a *screening* procedure to look for early signs of cancer in the colon or rectum. However, the test may reveal inflamed tissue, abnormal growths and ulcers. Special instruments can be passed through the colonoscope to remove any polyps if needed. In these cases, the *screening* colonoscopy results in a *diagnostic* or therapeutic procedure.

This policy describes Humana's billing expectation for distinguishing between a *screening* colonoscopy and a *screening* colonoscopy that results in a *diagnostic* or therapeutic procedure.

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In addition to the policy, claims payments are subject to other plan requirements for the processing and payment of claims, including, but not limited to, requirements of medical necessity and reasonableness and applicable referral or authorization requirements.

Humana plans may allow *screening* colonoscopies and *screening* colonoscopies that result in a *diagnostic* or therapeutic procedure. Members and providers should contact Humana for specific plan information.

- When billing *screening* services, healthcare providers must report an International Classification of Diseases (ICD) diagnosis code that accurately describes the *screening*.
- If the service begins as a *screening* procedure but results in a *diagnostic* or therapeutic procedure at the same operative session, healthcare providers should report an appropriate *screening* ICD diagnosis code as the primary diagnosis and the *diagnostic* or abnormal finding ICD diagnosis code as the secondary or subsequent diagnosis.
- When a *screening* results in a *diagnostic* or therapeutic procedure, as noted above, Humana will still allow the procedure as a *screening* if the following conditions are met:
  - The member has a *screening* colonoscopy benefit;
  - The claim contains both a *screening* and *diagnostic* diagnosis code and can be supported by medical records; and
  - The charge is not for a service performed more frequently than allowed, with respect to the previously allowed colorectal cancer *screening*, by Original Medicare guidelines.

Healthcare providers should report *modifiers PT* and *33* when appropriate.

Definitions of *Italicized* Terms

- ***Diagnostic***: Service or test performed to determine why symptoms exist.
- ***Modifier PT***: Colorectal cancer screening test; converted to diagnostic test or other procedure.
- ***Modifier 33***: Preventive services.
- ***Screening***: Preventive service or product provided to an individual without apparent signs or symptoms of an illness, injury or disease for the purpose of identifying or excluding an undiagnosed illness, disease or condition.

References

- Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services website. Medicare Benefit Policy Manual. Chapter 15 – Covered Medical and Other Health Services. Section 280.2 – Colorectal Cancer Screening. www.cms.gov.
- Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services website. Medicare Claims Processing Manual. Chapter 18 – Preventive and Screening Services. Section 60 – Colorectal Cancer Screening. www.cms.gov.
- Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services website. MLN Educational Tool. Medicare Preventive Services: Colorectal Cancer Screening Tests. www.cms.gov.
- Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services HCPCS Level II and associated publications and services.
- American Medical Association's Current Procedural Terminology (CPT®) and associated publications and services.

General Humana Resources

- Availity – Providers can register for access to information on a variety of topics such as eligibility, benefits, referrals, authorizations, claims and electronic remittances.
- Claims processing edit notifications – Alerts of upcoming claims payment changes are posted on the first Friday of each month.
- Claims resources – Providers can find information on referrals, authorizations, electronic claim submissions and more.
- Making it easier – This page contains an educational series for providers and healthcare professionals.

- Medical and pharmacy coverage policies – Humana publishes determinations of coverage of medical procedures, devices and medications for the treatment of various conditions. There may be variances in coverage among plans.
- Publications – This page can help you find our quarterly newsletter, provider manual and other resources to help you do business with us.

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